

Class 9 Employability Skills

Unit 1: Communication Skills – I

Chapter 1: Introduction to Communication

Chapter Overview

Imagine waking up in the morning and not being able to tell anyone how you feel. You cannot ask your parents for breakfast, answer your teacher's questions, send a text message to your friend, or even understand a traffic signal. Life would become very difficult.

Every day, we communicate in many ways. We speak, listen, write, read, smile, wave our hands, use emojis, send emails, and even look at signs and symbols. Communication is a part of everything we do.

Good communication helps us build friendships, perform well in school, work successfully with others, and solve problems peacefully. It is one of the most important life skills that every student should develop.

In this chapter, you will learn what communication is, why it is important, how it works, and how you can become a better communicator.

Learning Outcomes

After completing this chapter, you will be able to:

- Define communication.
 - Explain the importance of communication.
 - Describe the purpose of communication.
 - Identify different methods of communication.
 - Understand the communication cycle.
 - Develop effective speaking and listening skills.
 - Communicate politely and confidently in everyday life.
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Keywords

Communication • Message • Sender • Receiver • Feedback • Verbal • Non-verbal • Visual • Listening • Speaking

1.1 What is Communication?

Think About It

Look around your classroom.

- Your teacher is explaining a lesson.
- Students are listening carefully.
- One student raises a hand to ask a question.
- Another student smiles after understanding the answer.

All these actions are examples of **communication**.

Definition

Communication is the process of sharing information, ideas, thoughts, feelings, or messages between two or more people so that the message is understood correctly.

In simple words,

Communication means giving and receiving information.

Communication is not only about speaking. It also includes listening, reading, writing, observing, and understanding.

A Simple Example

Riya wants to borrow a notebook from her friend.

She says,

"May I borrow your notebook, please?"

Her friend replies,

"Yes, of course."

The message has been sent, understood, and answered. This is successful communication.

Another Example

The school bell rings.

Without anyone saying a word, students understand that the class is over.

This is also communication because the bell conveys a message.

Communication Happens Every Day

Communication takes place almost everywhere.

At home:

- Talking to parents.
- Asking for help.
- Discussing family plans.

At school:

- Asking questions.
- Listening to teachers.
- Working in groups.

In public places:

- Reading road signs.
- Buying tickets.
- Asking for directions.

Online:

- Sending emails.
- Chatting with friends.
- Attending online classes.

Did You Know?

A smile can communicate happiness.

A thumbs-up can communicate approval.

A red traffic light tells us to stop.

Communication is not always done using words.

Activity 1

Observe Your Morning

Think about everything you did from the time you woke up until you reached school.

Write down five examples of communication.

Situation	Type of Communication
Talking to parents	Speaking

Situation	Type of Communication
Reading the bus number	Visual
Greeting the teacher	Verbal
Listening to announcements	Listening
Watching traffic lights	Visual

1.2 Why Do We Communicate?

People communicate because they want others to understand their thoughts, feelings, or needs.

Imagine you are thirsty.

How will others know unless you tell them?

Suppose your teacher gives homework.

How will students complete it unless they understand the instructions?

Communication helps people understand each other.

Reasons We Communicate

We communicate to:

- Share information
 - Express feelings
 - Ask questions
 - Give instructions
 - Solve problems
 - Learn new things
 - Build relationships
 - Work together
 - Help others
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Example

Teacher:

"Tomorrow we will have a science test."

Students understand the information and prepare for the test.

This is communication.

1.3 Importance of Communication

Communication is an essential life skill.

Whether you are a student, teacher, doctor, engineer, entrepreneur, or artist, communication helps you succeed.

Let's understand why communication is important.

1. Communication Helps Us Learn

Students learn by listening to teachers, reading books, asking questions, and discussing ideas.

Example

A student asks,

"Why does it rain?"

The teacher explains the water cycle.

Learning happens through communication.

2. Communication Builds Relationships

Good communication helps us make friends and maintain healthy relationships.

When people communicate honestly and respectfully, trust grows.

Example

Two friends solve a misunderstanding by talking calmly instead of arguing.

3. Communication Helps in Teamwork

Many tasks require people to work together.

Sharing ideas helps everyone contribute.

Example

Students working on a science project discuss who will collect information, who will make charts, and who will present the project.

4. Communication Solves Problems

Many problems arise because people misunderstand each other.

Clear communication reduces confusion.

Example

A student accidentally takes another student's notebook.

Instead of fighting, they talk and solve the problem peacefully.

5. Communication Builds Confidence

Students who speak clearly and politely become more confident.

Confidence grows with practice.

Example

Giving a speech during the morning assembly helps improve communication skills.

6. Communication Helps in Careers

Employers value people who can communicate effectively.

Good communication helps during interviews, meetings, presentations, and customer interactions.

Almost every profession requires strong communication skills.

Life Skill Box

Good communication is not about speaking more.

It is about speaking clearly, listening carefully, and understanding others.

Activity 2

Discuss with your classmates.

Question:

Why is communication important for a doctor?

Write three reasons.

1.4 Purpose of Communication

Every communication has a purpose.

People communicate because they want to achieve something.

Purpose 1: To Share Information

We communicate to give or receive information.

Example

The principal announces,

"School will remain closed tomorrow due to heavy rain."

Students receive important information.

Purpose 2: To Express Thoughts and Feelings

Communication allows people to share emotions and opinions.

Example

A student tells the teacher,

"I enjoyed today's science experiment."

Purpose 3: To Give Instructions

Teachers, parents, and coaches often communicate instructions.

Example

"Complete your homework before Monday."

Purpose 4: To Ask Questions

Questions help us learn.

Example

"What is the capital of India?"

Purpose 5: To Persuade Others

Sometimes we communicate to convince people.

Example

A student encourages classmates to keep the classroom clean.

Purpose 6: To Entertain

Stories, jokes, songs, movies, and dramas entertain people through communication.

Purpose 7: To Build Relationships

Talking politely and respectfully strengthens relationships.

Real-Life Story

Aman was new to school.

He felt nervous and did not talk to anyone.

One day, he introduced himself to his classmates.

Soon, he made many friends.

This simple act of communication helped Aman feel happy and confident.

Moral: Good communication helps us connect with people.

Chapter Summary (Part 1)

- Communication is the process of sharing information, ideas, and feelings.
 - Communication is a two-way process involving a sender and a receiver.
 - We communicate every day using speech, writing, signs, gestures, and technology.
 - Good communication helps us learn, build relationships, solve problems, and work with others.
 - The purpose of communication includes sharing information, expressing feelings, asking questions, giving instructions, persuading others, entertaining people, and building relationships.
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Quick Check

Fill in the Blanks

1. Communication is a _____ process.
 2. We communicate to share _____.
 3. Good communication builds _____.
 4. Communication helps us solve _____.
 5. Asking questions is one purpose of _____.
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Short Answer Questions

1. What is communication?
2. Why is communication important for students?
3. Write any four purposes of communication.

4. Give two examples of communication in daily life.
5. How does communication help in teamwork?